Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 2 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
12° 9°	11° 7°	12° 7°	10° 4°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Five teenagers have been stabbed at a Halloween party in Hampshire, with police investigating the incident.**
Hampshire Police believe an unknown group managed to get into a private party in Chandler's Ford. The five young people were injured during the disturbance.
CRIME · UK

2 **King Charles III is set to address the issue of slavery during his visit to Antigua this week.**
The King will deliver a speech to the Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting on Tuesday, concluding his nine-day Caribbean tour. The Prime Minister has indicated he is open to a possible UK apology.
ROYALS · UK

3 **Thousands of jobs are expected to be cut at broadband provider Virgin Media O2.**
The company has not yet confirmed the exact number of roles that will be axed, but it's understood to be a significant portion of their workforce. This comes as a blow to the telecommunications sector.
ECONOMY · UK

4 **The family of Henry Nowak have spoken out about the trauma of seeing their son handcuffed as he lay dying.**
They described the harrowing night police informed them of his death, and the distress of watching him being handcuffed. The circumstances surrounding his death are still being investigated.
CRIME · UK

5 **More than 300 arrests have been made at a Palestine Action support protest outside the US embassy.**
This brings the total number of arrests for supporting the group to over 4,000 since it was proscribed in July 2025. Tensions remain high around such demonstrations.
PROTEST · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sir Tom Jones has mentored a Welsh singer to victory on The Voice UK this weekend!**

Cate McHugh was crowned the winner on Saturday night, with her proud coach Sir Tom Jones congratulating her. It's a fantastic start to the week for Welsh music!

ON AIR — What's your favourite talent show and why?

TV · WEEKEND

2 **Oscar Hartland, who played 'Neil the Baby' in Gavin and Stacey, hopes his band will be 'the next Stereophonics'.**

The young actor is now on a mission to create a new modern sound for Wales with his band. It's exciting to see him pursuing his musical ambitions!

ON AIR — Which child stars do you think made the best transition into music?

MUSIC · FUTURE

3 **Good news for aspiring performers in the North, as plans for a Brit School North arts college have been given the go-ahead!**

Inspired by the world-famous Brit School, this new college will be built in the centre of Bradford. It's fantastic news for nurturing new talent outside of London.

ON AIR — Do you think more specialist arts schools are needed across the UK?

EDUCATION · FUTURE

4 **After the nail-biting finale of Celebrity Traitors, industry experts are tipping certain stars for a big career boost.**

The second series of the hit show reached its climax on Friday, attracting millions of viewers. It seems some contestants are set to capitalise on their newfound fame.

ON AIR — Who do you think will get the biggest career boost from Celebrity Traitors?

TV · FUTURE

5 **The Gruffalo illustrator Axel Scheffler is considering legal action against AI firms.**

He believes companies are breaching copyright by reproducing his work in AI-generated Gruffalo images. This could be a significant case for artists and AI.

ON AIR — Do you think AI should be allowed to use copyrighted artwork to generate new images?

ART · FUTURE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Ruthless Chelsea have put six goals past Charlton to return to the top of the Women's Super League!**

Charlton are yet to earn a point this season, while Chelsea have now scored 27 goals in just eight games. They're looking incredibly strong at the moment.

ON AIR — Can anyone stop Chelsea in the WSL this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Grant Hardie has clinched a record-equalling fifth European Curling Championship gold for Scotland!**

Scotland edged out Italy 6-5 in a thrilling final in the Czech Republic. It's a fantastic achievement for Hardie and the Scottish team.

ON AIR — Curling is often seen as a niche sport – but do you enjoy watching it?

CURLING · UK

3 **Carlos Alcaraz has maintained his perfect record in ATP 500 events by winning the Vienna Open!**

He secured a straight-set victory over Alex de Minaur. Alcaraz continues to impress on the tennis circuit, showing incredible form.

ON AIR — Is Alcaraz the most exciting young talent in men's tennis right now?

TENNIS · EUROPEAN

4 **Harry Kane missed a penalty for Bayern Munich before a late Dortmund goal earned a draw in Der Klassiker.**

Bayern were held to a 2-2 draw with Borussia Dortmund after Fabio Silva's late equaliser. It was a dramatic end to a huge fixture for Kane and his team.

ON AIR — How much pressure is on Harry Kane to deliver trophies for Bayern this season?

FOOTBALL · EUROPEAN

5 **Marc Marquez has extended his MotoGP lead by winning the Malaysian Grand Prix!**

The reigning champion now holds a 44-point lead over title rival Jorge Martin. It's looking good for Marquez to retain his championship.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite MotoGP rider to watch, and why?

MOTORCYCLING · INTERNATIONAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Many are finding unexpected comfort in the gentle art of 'rearranging fridge magnets' into new, pleasing patterns.**
It seems the simple act of creating a fresh display on the fridge door can be a surprisingly soothing activity after a busy day, bringing a touch of mindful calm to the kitchen.

2 **The quiet satisfaction of 'watching a kettle boil' to perfection is gaining a surprising new appreciation.**
In our fast-paced world, there's a growing trend to slow down and observe these small, everyday moments, finding a moment of peace before that lovely cup of tea.

3 **People are reporting a renewed fondness for the 'humble garden gnome', seeing them as cheerful, quirky guardians.**
These often-overlooked garden figures are making a comeback, bringing a touch of whimsical charm and personality to outdoor spaces across the country.

4 **The delightful discovery of 'a forgotten packet of biscuits' at the back of the cupboard is sparking joy for many.**
It's like finding a small treasure, offering an unexpected treat and a welcome surprise, especially when you thought you were all out!

5 **There's a growing online community dedicated to sharing 'oddly satisfying moments of symmetry' found in daily life.**
From perfectly stacked items in a shop to a flawless reflection in a puddle, these fleeting visual harmonies are proving to be a surprising source of collective delight.

6 **The simple pleasure of 'hearing the post drop through the letterbox' is being highlighted as a daily moment of connection.**
Even in the digital age, that distinctive thud can still bring a small sense of anticipation and a reminder of tangible communication.

7 **Many are embracing the nostalgic charm of 're-reading a favourite childhood book' for comfort and escapism.**
Diving back into familiar stories from younger years offers a lovely way to unwind and revisit simpler times, often revealing new layers of meaning.

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05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if a new pot of jam in the supermarket will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY SHAKING IT TO CHECK THE CONSISTENCY — AS IF THAT TELLS US ANYTHING!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF BEFORE EVEN UNWRAPPING IT, JUST TO FULLY 'EXPERIENCE' ITS FRAGRANCE!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday pattern' or design just instantly makes you feel calm or happy?**
  Perhaps it's the neat rows of bricks on an old wall, or the swirling foam on your morning coffee. What patterns in everyday life bring a little bit of unexpected joy to your day?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household task' that, for some reason, we genuinely enjoy doing.**
  Is it sorting laundry by colour, carefully loading the dishwasher, or perhaps wiping down the kitchen surfaces? Which household chore do you secretly (or openly!) find satisfying?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that in ancient Rome, a dedicated team of pigeons was trained to deliver urgent messages to the Emperor, flying across the city with tiny scrolls tied to their legs.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- It is impossible to hum while holding your nose.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- The 'richest' bird in the world is the Ostrich, as its eggs are the largest and most valuable.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 2 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 306 of the year, 59 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Agapius and companions; Christian feast day: Domninus of Vienne; Christian feast day: Erc of Slane (Ireland); Christian feast day: Justus of Trieste. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1921 — Shepard Menken, American actor (died 1999)
- 1975 — Chris Walla, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1962 — Derek Mountfield, English footballer and manager
- 1959 — Peter Mullan, Scottish actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Kate Linder, American actress
- 1974 — Nelly, American rapper
- 1974 — Prodigy, American rapper (died 2017)
- 1928 — James Luisi, American basketball player and actor (died 2002)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1965 — Norman Morrison, a 31-year-old Quaker, sets himself on fire in front of the river entrance to the Pentagon to protest the use of napalm in the Vietnam war.
- 1956 — Suez Crisis: Israel occupies the Gaza Strip.
- 1988 — LOT Polish Airlines Flight 703 crashes in Białobrzegi, Podkarpackie Voivodeship, Poland, killing one person and injuring several more.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1959 — Quiz show scandals: Twenty-One game show contestant Charles Van Doren admits to a Congressional committee that he had been given questions and answers in advance.
- 1997 — Tropical Storm Linda makes landfall in the Mekong Delta in Vietnam, causing more than 3,000 deaths.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2000 — Expedition 1 arrived at the International Space Station for the first long-duration stay onboard. From this day to present, a continuous human presence in space on the station remains uninterrupted.
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1960 — Penguin Books is found not guilty of obscenity in the trial R v Penguin Books Ltd, the Lady Chatterley's Lover case.

- 1986 — Lebanon hostage crisis: U.S. hostage David Jacobsen is released in Beirut after 17 months in captivity.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 3 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 307 of the year, 58 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepsimas of Hnaita and companions (Greek Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Alpaïs of Cudot; Christian feast day: Elias I of Antioch (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ermengol (Hermengaudius). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Mick Thomson, American guitarist
- 1956 — Kevin Murphy, American actor, puppeteer, producer, and screenwriter
- 1963 — Ian Wright, English footballer, manager, and sportscaster
- 1924 — Marc Breaux, American actor, director, and choreographer (died 2013)
- 1957 — Gary Olsen, English actor (died 2000)
- 1953 — Helios Creed, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Mike Evans, American actor and screenwriter (died 2006)
- 1973 — Ben Fogle, English television host and author

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — Space Shuttle program: Atlantis launches on STS-66.
- 1979 — Greensboro massacre: Five members of the Communist Workers Party are shot dead and seven are wounded by a group of Klansmen and neo-Nazis during a "Death to the Klan" rally in Greensboro, North Carolina, United States.
- 1992 — Democratic Arkansas Governor Bill Clinton defeats Republican President George H. W. Bush and Independent candidate Ross Perot in the 1992 United States presidential election.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1973 — Mariner program: NASA launches the Mariner 10 toward Mercury. On March 29, 1974, it becomes the first space probe to reach that planet.
- 1976 — Carrie, an American supernatural horror film directed by Brian De Palma, is premiered in 17 theaters in the Washington, D.C.-Baltimore area.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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